

Syd Polk

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SUMMARY

Seasoned software developer and manager with experience in all aspects of software development. Amateur baseball analyst.

EDUCATION

Rice University, Houston, Texas - Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science.

BASEBALL

- Project Scoresheet 1987-1990 – Scorer for Houston Astros 1987-1988, San Francisco Giants/Oakland Athletics 1988-1990
- Project Retrosheet 2000 – Input games into Retrosheet system from original press scoresheets for Houston Astros, 1973 and 1974 seasons.
- SABR member since 2022.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Indeed, Inc., Austin, TX.

Senior Software Engineer, April 2016-present.

Senior Software Engineer, Mobile Applications, April 2022-date.

- Developed user-facing native features using SwiftUI and GraphQL for [Indeed's Job Search app](#).
 - The number of opt outs of all push notifications per day has dropped 30% since Native Push Notification Preferences was rolled out in January 2024.
 - Engagement between employers and job seekers using Indeed's messaging has increased 9% since the native messaging was rolled out in late 2024.
- Established an on-call system for mobile engineers based on a Datadog-based monitoring system for our mobile native applications.
 - ~30 engineers in on-call rotation
 - Developed Datadog logging and metrics in the iOS Job Search app.
 - Developed runbooks and dashboards as resources during on-call events.
 - The average time from when an outage started until the team was notified dropped from >120 minutes to < 5 minutes.
- Developed integration with Indeed's A/B testing system in the IOS Job Search app, enabling A/B tests of features and improvements.

Site Reliability Engineer (1 quarter rotation), April-July, 2021.

- Worked with one engineering team establishing SLO for its service

Software Engineer, Job Search Native API – November 2018-April 2022.

- Developed and evangelized GraphQL technology within Indeed.
 - Implemented GraphQL-based microservices.
 - Converted existing microservices from REST to GraphQL.
 - Developed demonstration GraphQL clients.
 - Advised and mentored other teams implementing GraphQL.
- Split a small but important service from our main job search webserver for use as a microservice.
 - Service handles several million requests a week that would have otherwise been handled by the main Indeed server, decreasing request latency and memory pressure. Handles 100M+ requests/month with an internal latency average < 100ms, and availability 99.0%
- Developed high-volume client logging library using Kafka and Avro that can handle tens of millions of logs per day from the GlassDoor native application.

Software Engineer, Job Search Front End – April 2016-November 2018.

- A/B testing of various features on the job viewing web page; increased user engagement 5-8%.
- Made build system improvements that resulting in our builds being 25-30% faster.
- Participated in hundreds of onsite interviews for potential candidates to work at Indeed.

Mozilla, Inc., Mountain View, CA (remote).

Technical Lead, Platform QA, April 2014-April 2016.

- Developed Black Box test plan for Firefox's implementation of WebRTC.
- Wrote automation for regression testing of Firefox's streaming playback of web content, with and without DRM.

Klink LLC, Austin, Texas.

Mac OS X Programmer, August 2013-April 2014.

- Used Objective C, Python and PyObjC to develop user interface for cloud syncing application.
- Used Python to implement syncing via RESTful interfaces.
- Reduced open bug count by 80%.

Spawn Labs, Austin, Texas.

QA & Release Engineer Manager, September 2012-August 2013.

- Wrote overall test plan for Spawn's cloud gaming service.
- Worked to establish CI/CD builds for each of the different pieces of the service, which were all based on different technologies.

Increased performance of the build of the main kernel 100% by automating application of kernel patches

Rock Systems, Durango, Colorado (remote).

Consultant – iOS Development, April 2012-August 2012.

- Identified and fixed 80+ defects in Airborne Media Group's **Audio Air** iOS app (now discontinued), including many crashing defects that would have been triggered within 5 minutes of launch.
- Version 1.3 shipped in the App Store in September 2012.

Coverity Software (now Synopsis), San Francisco, California (remote).

Senior QA Manager and QA Architect, July 2008-May 2012

Lombardi Software (now IBM), Austin, Texas.

QA Manager, May 2006-June 2008

Apple Computer (now Apple, Inc.), Cupertino, California.

Xcode Tools QA & Integration Manager, May 2001-April 2006

Red Hat, Inc./Cygnus Solutions, Sunnyvale, California.

Engineering Manager, November 1997-May 2001

Sun Microsystems Laboratories (now Oracle Laboratories), Mountain View, California.

Member of Technical Staff, March 1996 to November 1997

Claris Corporation (now Claris International), Santa Clara, California / **StyleWare, Inc.**, Houston, Texas

Software Engineer, December 1987-March 1996

SKILLS

Swift, SwiftUI, UIKit Combine, Xcode, Bash/shell scripting, Java, GraphQL, Apollo Federation, Python, Spring, Spring Boot, Objective C, RESTful APIs, Javascript, Soy, HTML, CSS, Django, C, SQL, Perl, Tcl, Ruby, Eclipse, MacOS, iOS, Unix, Linux, Windows, Visual Studio, cvs, Subversion, Perforce, git, Bitkeeper, Mercurial, gcc, Jenkins, VMWare, Cocoa, Bugzilla, JIRA, yocto, repo, vagrant, VirtualBox, Marionette, hobo, Datadog, Terraform, Kubernetes, Avro, Kafka, Docker, make, Subversion, Pascal, Assembly Language

ONLINE PUBLICATIONS

[Recruited By Tech](#) – a blog about interviewing for jobs in the tech sector.

[Middle-class Tech](#) – a newsletter about my life in the tech sector.

[Not Your Ordinary Computer Geek](#) – Personal blog, where I reflect on many life experiences, including baseball.